RIYADH · DAMMAM · SAUDI ARABIA

20 OCTOBER 2026

Saudi Airports Status

Incident summary and airport deep dives · as of 8:52 PM, Tuesday 20 October 2026, Riyadh time (UTC+3)

Riyadh airport **Halted** · 304 cancelled today | Dammam airport **Disrupted** · 57 cancelled

Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,930 minutes at 9:00 PM (only movement since 6 PM: Saudia SV979 from Guangzhou landed at 7:51 PM); Dammam moving after a 54-minute halt from 7:43 to 8:37 PM

INCIDENT SUMMARY

1 What is happening now, at both airports and across the Kingdom.

HEADLINE

- **Riyadh airport halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct, 12,930 minutes at 9:00 PM; since 6 PM no takeoffs and one landing (Saudia SV979 from Guangzhou, 7:51 PM)**.
- 304 Tuesday Riyadh flights cancelled (51%), and NOTAM A3650/26 still requires prior GACA permission for every flight.
- Coalition says it destroyed the Houthi launcher used for today's ballistic missile attack on Riyadh (8:06 PM); no new attack on Saudi Arabia reported since 6 PM.
- Saudi and Kuwaiti foreign ministers condemn the continuing Houthi attacks on Saudi civilian areas; Islamic foreign ministers also condemn the attacks.
- Dammam airport moving after a 54-minute halt (7:43 to 8:37 PM): 9 takeoffs and 6 landings since 6 PM, latest flyadeal F3471 to Al-Qassim at 8:47 PM.

RIYADH AIRPORT RUH

HALTED

No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12923 min).

304	0/0	8
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

DAMMAM AIRPORT DMM

DISRUPTED

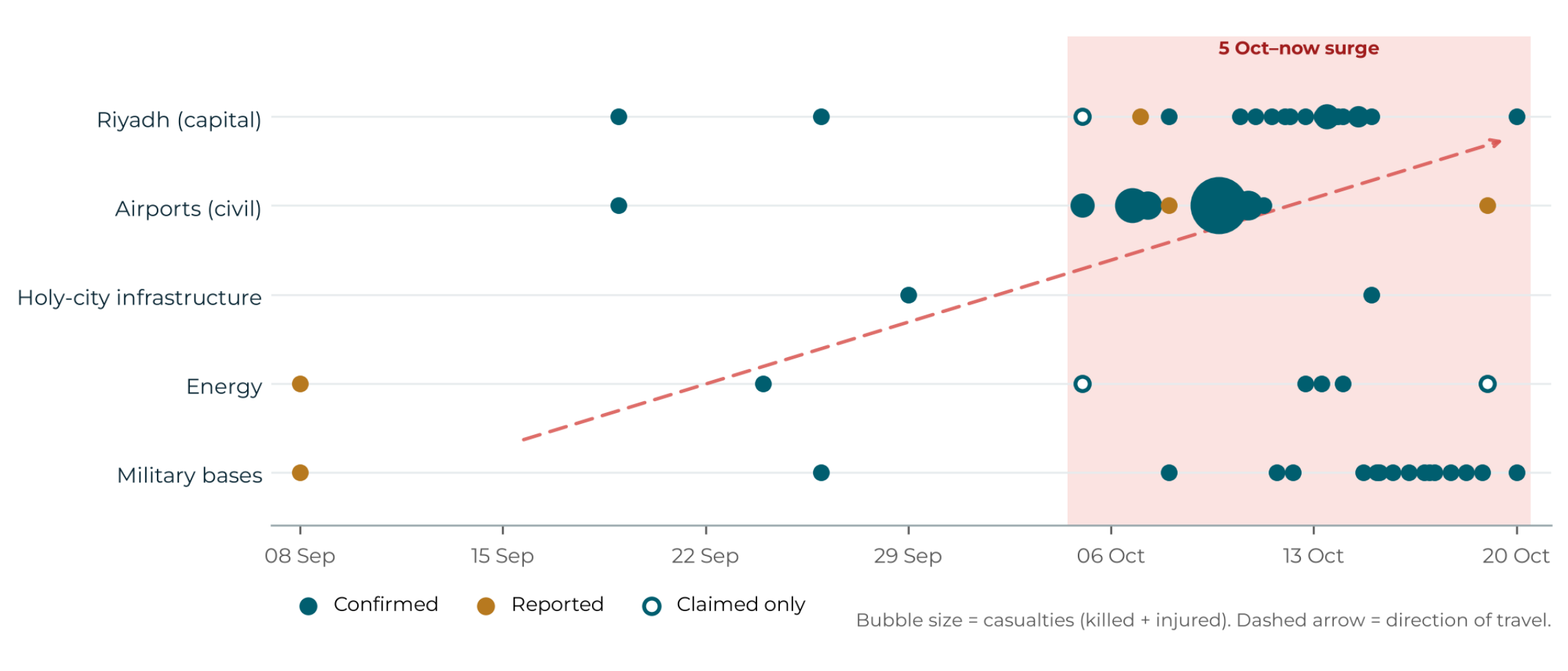
5 takeoffs and 0 landings in the last hour.

57	5/0	0
CANCELLED TODAY	TAKEOFFS/LANDINGS, 1H	DIVERTED

WHAT CHANGED IN THE LAST HOUR

- Riyadh still halted since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct (12,930 min at 9:00 PM); since 6 PM no takeoffs and one landing (Saudia SV979 from Guangzhou, 7:51 PM)
- Coalition: launcher used for today's ballistic missile attack on Riyadh destroyed (8:06 PM); no new attack on Saudi Arabia since 6 PM
- Saudi and Kuwaiti foreign ministers condemn continuing Houthi attacks on Saudi civilian areas (SPA, 8:22 PM)
- Flightradar24: Riyadh open with prior permission, but no passenger flight has sought it; only private and cargo flights since reopening
- Dammam moving after a 54-minute halt (7:43 to 8:37 PM): 9 takeoffs and 6 landings since 6 PM, latest flyadeal F3471 to Al-Qassim at 8:47 PM

ESCALATION PATTERN: HOUTHI STRIKES ON KSA BY TARGET TYPE, 8 SEP – 20 OCT



54 sourced events since 8 September (46 confirmed). Latest: Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region (20 Oct, Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox) / SPA; none reported). Each event has a source link in strikes.json and on the website. Filled = confirmed officially; amber = reported by credible media; hollow = claimed only (Houthi or unattributed). Events without a source are not plotted.

SO WHAT

The campaign has climbed an escalation ladder: from military targets to economic targets (Aramco, Yanbu), then to symbolic targets (the Madinah power station serving the Prophet's Mosque), and now to civilian aviation and the capital. King Khalid International Airport has been hit or targeted on 19 Sep, 5, 7, 8, 10 and 11 Oct; the 10–11 Oct strikes closed it indefinitely. On the evening of 11 Oct GACA confirmed a further attack on Dammam's King Fahd International Airport. Each rung raises the reputational cost to the Kingdom more than the military cost.

ATTACKS, INTERCEPTIONS & ALERTS (KSA-WIDE)

2 Every attack, interception, Civil Defense alert and all-clear, debris fall and casualty report since 6:00 PM.

Sources: Coalition spokesman, SPA, Civil Defense, Interior and Energy ministries, Al Ekhbariya, Reuters/AP. Riyadh time.

No new attacks, interceptions or alerts since 6:00 PM AST.

Last 24 hours: Attacks 2, interceptions 3, alerts 1, all-clears 1.

NEWS AND STATEMENTS

3 Coalition destroys the launcher behind today's Riyadh missile; Saudi, Kuwaiti and Islamic foreign ministers condemn Houthi attacks; Riyadh airport still halted

Checked at 8:53 PM: Reuters, AP, AFP, Arab News, SPA, GACA, Flightradar24 on X. Times are publication or post times, Riyadh time.

UNVERIFIED **Islamic foreign ministers condemn Houthi aggression on Saudi Arabia**

Saudi Gazette (@Saudi_Gazette) · **8:30 PM** · published 8:30 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; single newspaper report, statement text not yet checked; checked 8:53 PM

Saudi Gazette reports that foreign ministers of Islamic countries condemned the Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia.

CONFIRMED **Saudi and Kuwaiti foreign ministers condemn continuing Houthi attacks on civilian areas in the Kingdom**

SPA (@SPAregions) · **8:22 PM** · published 8:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, translated from Arabic); checked 8:53 PM

SPA says the Saudi Foreign Minister and Kuwait's Foreign Minister discussed regional developments by phone and condemned the continuing attacks by the Houthi militia on civilian areas in the Kingdom, stressing the two countries' solidarity.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: launcher used for today's ballistic missile attack on Riyadh destroyed**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **8:06 PM** · published 8:06 PM AST (Arabic), SPA English 8:20 PM; also Al Ekhbariya, Arab News, Saudi Gazette; checked 8:53 PM

The coalition says it destroyed the platform the Houthi militia used to launch the ballistic missile fired at Riyadh earlier on Tuesday, which was intercepted at 11:39 AM.

CORROBORATED **Flightradar24: Riyadh airport open with prior permission, but no passenger flight has sought it**

Flightradar24 (@flightradar24) · **6:26 PM** · published 6:26 PM AST; matches the Riyadh board (only private, cargo-series and diverted traffic); checked 8:53 PM

Flightradar24 says Riyadh airport is open to traffic with prior permission, but no passenger flight has sought that permission so far, and only private and cargo flights have operated since the reopening.

CONFIRMED **Coalition: drone intercepted and destroyed over the Riyadh region**

Coalition spokesman (@CJFCSpox); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **5:22 PM** · published 5:22 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA Arabic 5:24 PM, SPA English 5:31 PM, Al Ekhbariya 5:25 PM; checked 5:55 PM

Coalition spokesman Maj. Gen. Turki Al-Maliki said a drone was intercepted and destroyed in the Riyadh region. It is the second Riyadh-area intercept today after the 11:39 AM ballistic missile. No debris, damage or casualties have been reported, and no Civil Defense alert for it appeared on the official account.

CORROBORATED **Reuters: most Gulf stock markets slip after new Houthi claims against Saudi energy and airport sites**

Reuters (@Reuters) · **4:10 PM** · posted 4:10 PM AST Tue 20 Oct; checked 5:55 PM; the Houthi claims themselves are not confirmed by Saudi authorities; Reuters updated the story at 8:20 PM AST

Reuters reported that most Gulf bourses retreated on Tuesday after the Houthis claimed operations against Saudi energy and airport sites. Saudi authorities have not confirmed those claims.

CONFIRMED **Saudi Cabinet welcomes the UN Security Council condemnation of Houthi attacks on airports and energy sites**

Al Ekhbariya (@alekhbariyatv); SPA (@Spa_Eng) · **3:19 PM** · published 3:19 PM AST Tue 20 Oct (official account, Arabic, translated); SPA English 3:30 PM; Al Arabiya English 4:19 PM; checked 5:55 PM

At the weekly session chaired by King Salman in Riyadh, the Cabinet welcomed the Security Council's condemnation of Houthi attacks on civilian sites, airports and energy infrastructure in the Kingdom and of the continuing threats to shipping in the Red Sea and Bab el-Mandeb. The statement did not mention any change to Riyadh airport operations.

CORROBORATED **Reuters: airlines keep cancelling Saudi flights; Air France-KLM to 7 Nov, Lufthansa to 18 Nov, Delta's Riyadh launch moved to March 2027**

Reuters factbox (via Investing.com); Semafor; Gulf Business · **3:14 PM** · Semafor summary of the Reuters report 3:14 PM AST (8:14 AM EDT) Tue 20 Oct; Gulf Business 1:53 PM; checked 5:55 PM

Reuters says Riyadh airport reopened at the weekend but every departure and landing needs GACA permission. Air France-KLM extended its Riyadh suspension to 7 November, Lufthansa Group to 18 November, Philippine Airlines to 29 November and Cathay Pacific to 31 January 2027, while Delta pushed its Atlanta to Riyadh launch to March 2027 and Gulf Air flights remained suspended.

CONFIRMED **UK to fly RAF Typhoon defensive patrols to protect Saudi cities and infrastructure from Houthi attacks**

UK Ministry of Defence (GOV.UK); AP, BBC, The National · **1:59 PM** · GOV.UK operational update published 1:59 PM AST (10:59 UTC) Tue 20 Oct; BBC 2:09 PM, AP updated 4:32 PM; checked 5:55 PM

Defence Secretary Wes Streeting approved RAF Typhoon jets for defensive counter-air missions to intercept Houthi missiles and drones over Saudi Arabia; the UK says they will not strike targets in Yemen. The package adds an A400M Atlas transport aircraft and military advisers, and extends existing air-to-air refuelling support.

KING KHALID INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · RIYADH

4 Riyadh airport: halted. No takeoff or landing since 9:29 PM (12923 min).

304	5:36 PM	7:51 PM	0	8
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
146 departures + 158 arrivals, 51% of 593 scheduled.	0S2828 to Milan, 196 min before 8:52 PM.	SV979 from Guangzhou, 61 min before 8:52 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	Mostly to Jeddah, Dammam, Qassim.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 RUH board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:52 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 285 at 8:53 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	146	158	304	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	136 (45%)	149 (51%)	285	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	2 (1%)	1 (0%)	3	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	4 (67%)	3 (75%)	7	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	0 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	2 of 265	1 of 243	3 of 508	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	8	8	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	25	31	56	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	72	100	172	FR24 stats panel

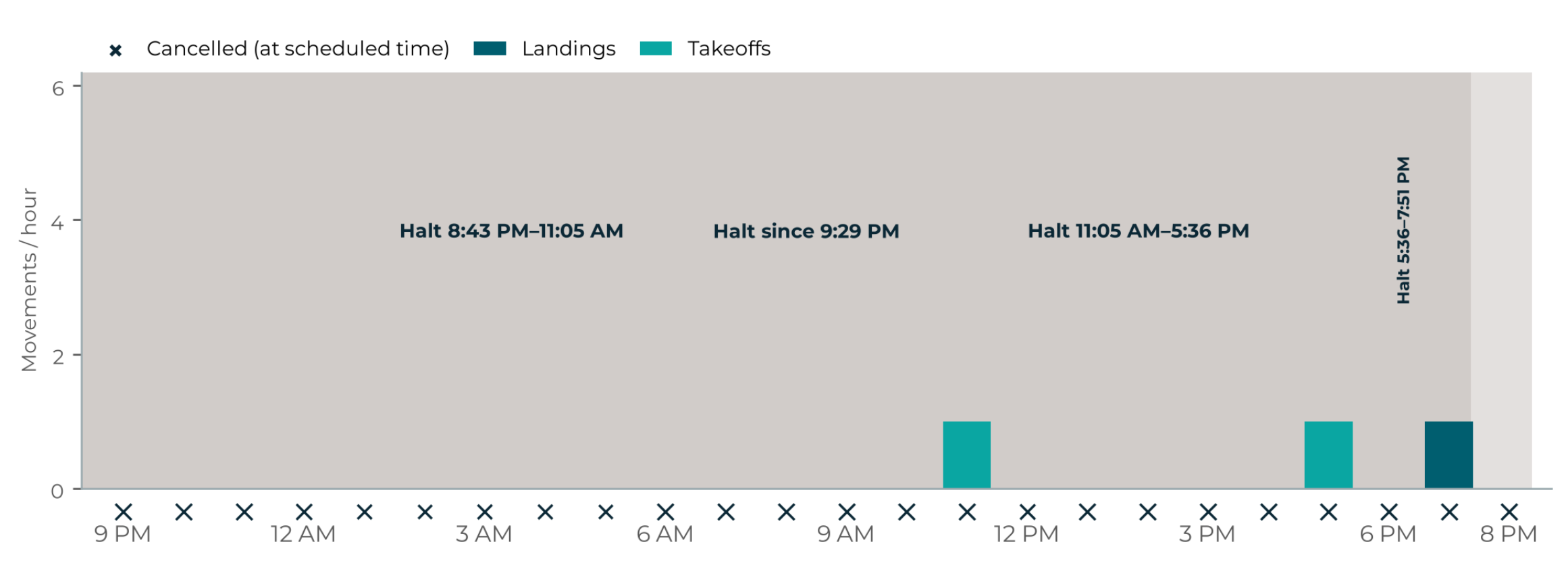
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	202
flynas	34
flyadeal	15
Gulf Air	8
Emirates	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Jeddah	55
Madinah	28
Dammam	24
Dubai	22
Abha	18

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · RUH



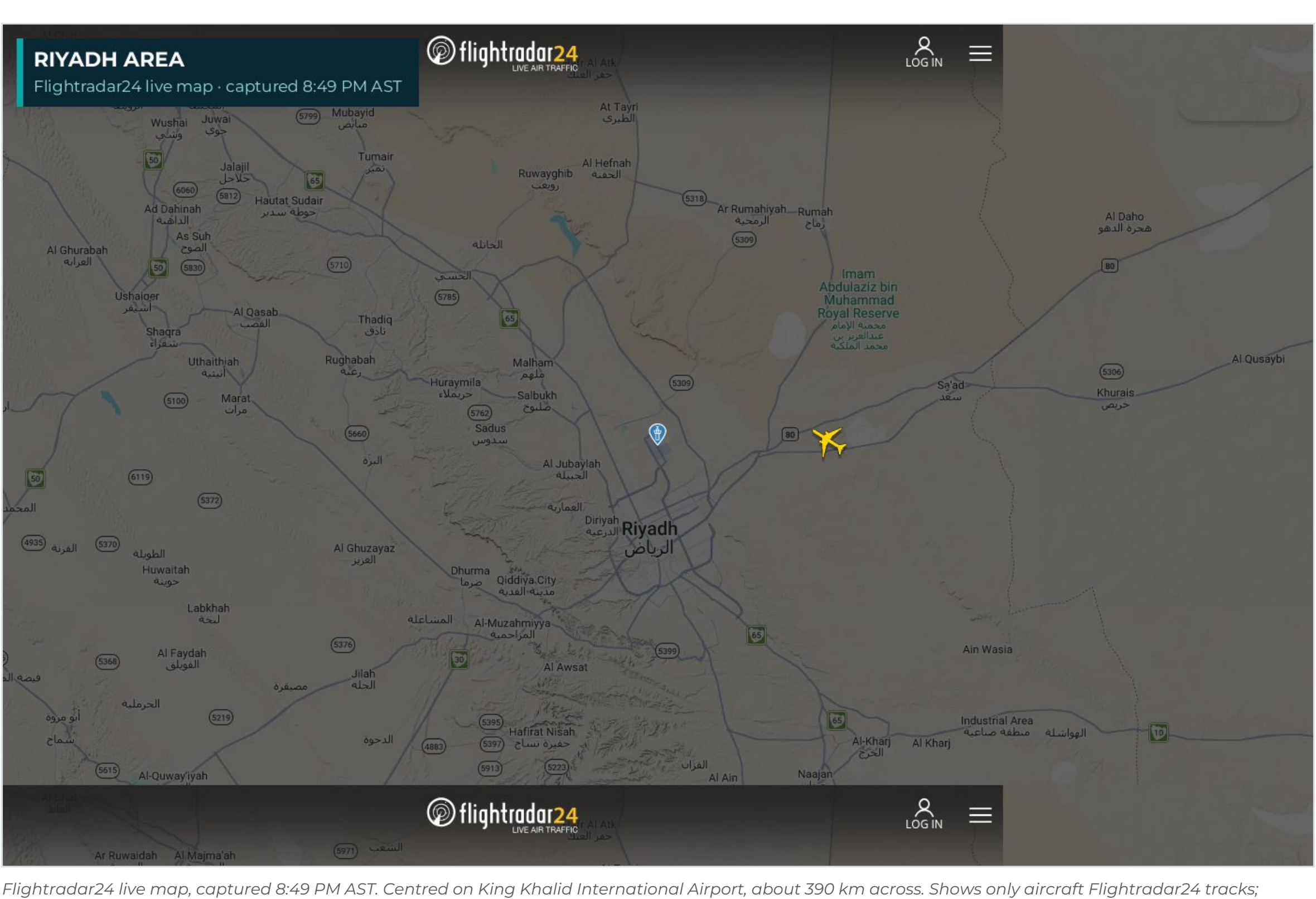
Recorded takeoffs (2) and landings (1) at RUH per hour from 9:00 PM Monday to 8:52 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 RUH departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Gray boxes mark halts of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing, worked out from the Flightradar24 board and kept until they roll out of the 24-hour window. Riyadh's open halt since 9:29 PM Sunday 11 Oct covers the whole window; the only Riyadh movements in it are non-scheduled flights: landings SV918 at 4:27 PM and N437GA at 8:43 PM Monday, and the private-jet takeoff HZSK5 to Geneva at 11:05 AM Tuesday. Dammam's halts in the window ran 12:41–1:48 AM, 2:04–2:53 AM, 5:15–6:17 AM and 7:13–8:11 AM Tuesday; Dammam has had no halt since 8:11 AM; its longest gap since 12:00 PM was 17 minutes.

HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 5:36–7:51 PM	135 min
Halt 11:05 AM–5:36 PM	391 min
Halt 8:43 PM–11:05 AM	862 min
OPEN Halt since 9:29 PM	12923 min and counting

AIRSPACE NOW · RIYADH AREA



Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:49 PM AST. Centred on King Khalid International Airport, about 390 km across. Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

KING FAHD INTERNATIONAL AIRPORT · DAMMAM

5 Dammam airport: disrupted. 5 takeoffs and 0 landings in the last hour.

57	8:47 PM	7:27 PM	5	0
FLIGHTS CANCELLED TODAY	LAST TAKEOFF	LAST LANDING	TAKEOFFS, LAST HOUR	ARRIVALS DIVERTED
28 departures + 29 arrivals, 26% of 220 scheduled.	F3471 to Qassim, 5 min before 8:52 PM.	F3432 from Abha, 85 min before 8:52 PM.	0 landings in the last hour.	None recorded today.

Cancellation basis: *Flightradar24 DMM board count, departures + arrivals scheduled on the local day (midnight to midnight, Riyadh time), all pages including flights still to come, codeshares and identical rows de-duplicated; boards fetched 8:52 PM. Flightradar24's own stats panel shows 55 at 8:53 PM; the panel updates a few minutes behind the board.*

FLIGHTRADAR24 AIRPORT STATS

MEASURE	DEPARTURES	ARRIVALS	TOTAL	BASIS
Cancelled today, board count	28	29	57	FR24 boards, local day
Cancelled today, stats panel	27 (24%)	28 (26%)	55	FR24 stats panel
Delayed today	24 (21%)	11 (10%)	35	FR24 stats panel
On time today (share of operated)	28 (54%)	38 (78%)	66	FR24 stats panel
Average delay, recent flights	0 min	5 min	—	FR24 stats panel
Operated since midnight vs scheduled so far	55 of 92	43 of 91	98 of 183	FR24 boards
Diverted today	—	0	0	FR24 arrivals board
Already cancelled tomorrow	13	16	29	FR24 stats panel
Cancelled yesterday (for scale)	15	18	33	FR24 stats panel

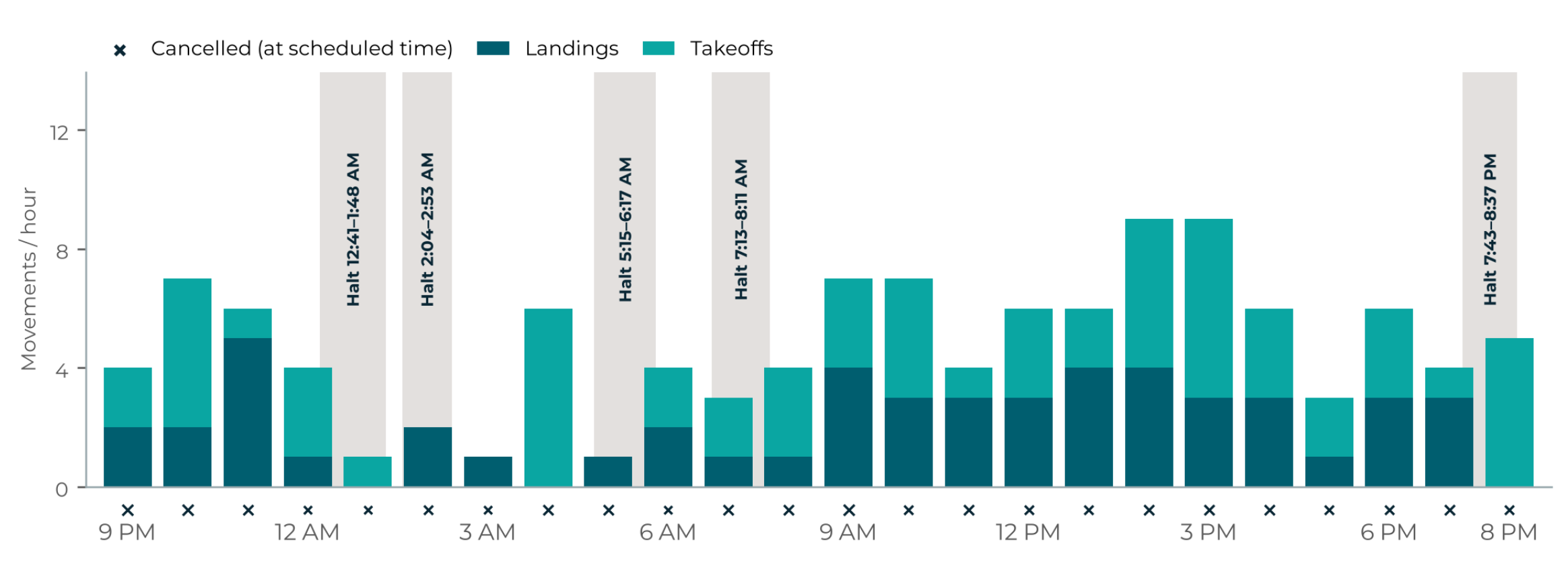
CANCELLATIONS BY AIRLINE, TOP 5

Saudia	21
flydubai	8
Egyptair	6
Emirates	6
Etihad Airways	6

MOST-CANCELLED ROUTES, TOP 5

Riyadh	24
Dubai	14
Cairo	6
Abu Dhabi	6
Madinah	4

TAKEOFFS AND LANDINGS PER HOUR, LAST 24 HOURS · DMM



Recorded takeoffs (63) and landings (52) at DMM per hour from 9:00 PM Monday to 8:52 PM, Riyadh time; the newest bar is the current, partial hour. × marks flights cancelled, at their scheduled time. Gray boxes are halts: 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing on the board, kept until they roll out of the window. Source: Flightradar24 DMM departures and arrivals boards, fetched read-only.

Moving, no open halt at 9:00 PM after a 54-minute halt from 7:43 to 8:37 PM: 5 takeoffs and 0 landings in the last hour; 9 takeoffs and 6 landings since 6 PM.

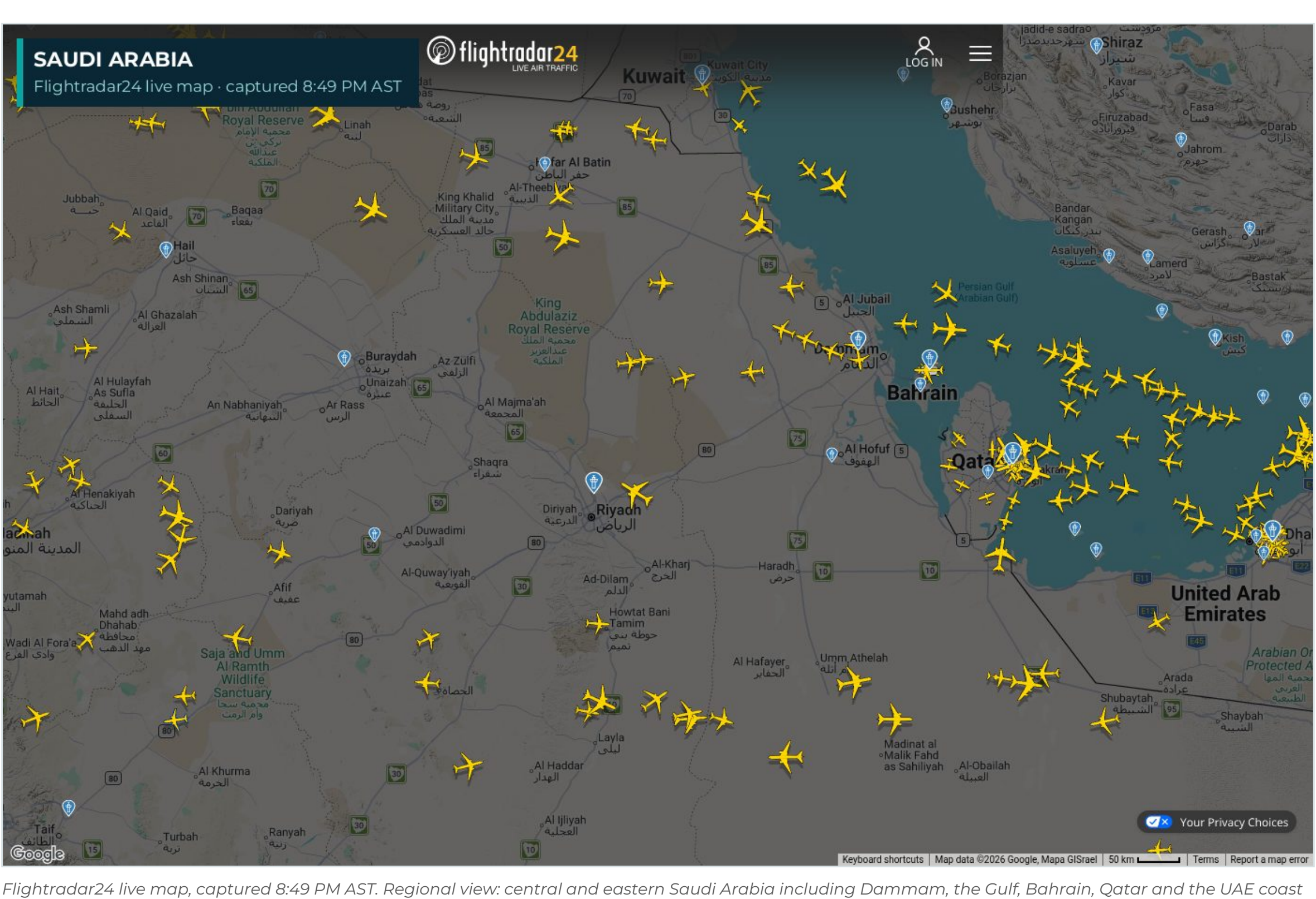
HALTS IN THE LAST 24 HOURS

Halt 7:43–8:37 PM	54 min
Halt 7:13–8:11 AM	58 min
Halt 5:15–6:17 AM	62 min
Halt 2:04–2:53 AM	49 min
Halt 12:41–1:48 AM	66 min

DAMMAM AIRPORT NEWS

No Dammam airport-specific statement or credible report found in this edition's news check (8:53 PM).

AIRSPACE NOW · SAUDI ARABIA



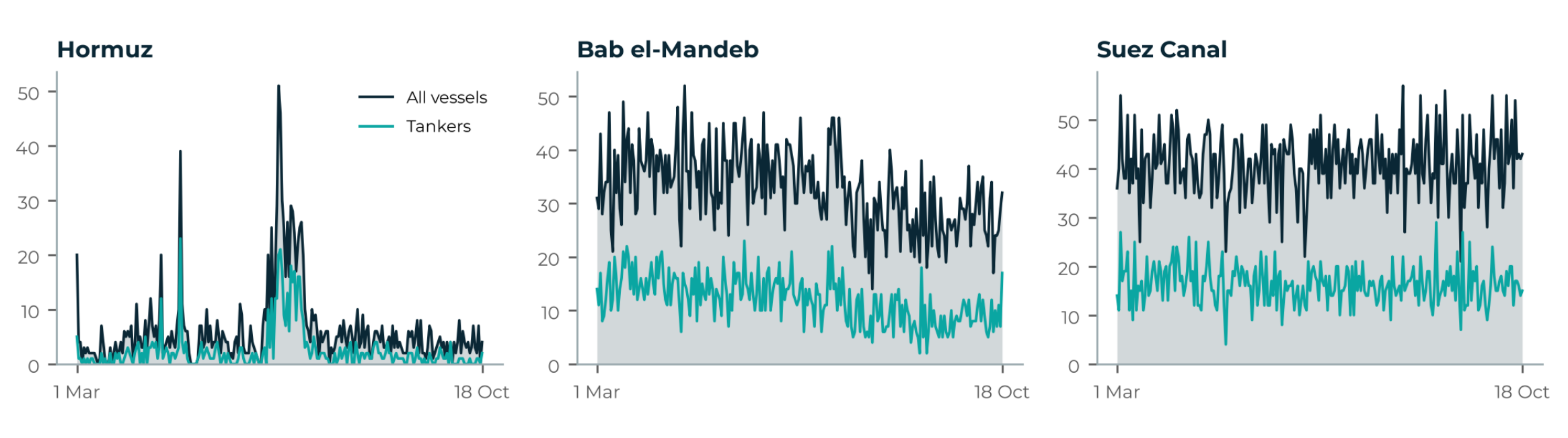
Flightradar24 live map, captured 8:49 PM AST. Regional view: central and eastern Saudi Arabia including Dammam, the Gulf, Bahrain, Qatar and the UAE coast (no Dammam-only view is captured). Shows only aircraft Flightradar24 tracks; military and transponder-off flights do not appear.

ECONOMY

6 Oil and shipping: Hormuz and Red Sea transits, Saudi crude exports, Brent crude.

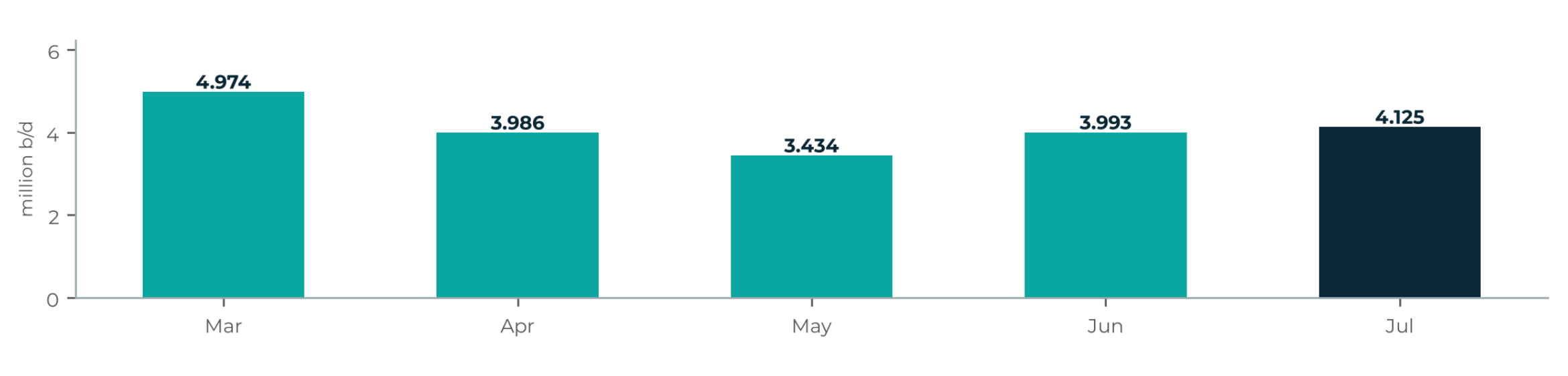
SHIPPING THROUGH HORMUZ AND THE RED SEA (IMF PORTWATCH, DAILY, LAGGED)

CHOKEPOINT	LATEST DAY	ALL VESSELS	TANKERS	OTHER SHIPS	7-DAY AVG (PRIOR 7)
Hormuz	Sun 18 Oct	**4**	2	2	3.7 (4.1)
Bab el-Mandeb	Sun 18 Oct	**32**	17	15	26.4 (28.3)
Suez Canal	Sun 18 Oct	**43**	15	28	44.3 (41.7)



Source: IMF PortWatch daily chokepoint transits (AIS-based, both directions combined; PortWatch does not split inbound and outbound), since 1 March 2026. ***Daily, lagged about 4 to 7 days.*** *Fetched 8:53 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST. Red Sea = Bab el-Mandeb (southern entrance) and Suez Canal (northern exit).*

SAUDI CRUDE OIL EXPORTS, JODI MONTHLY AVERAGE (MILLION BARRELS PER DAY)

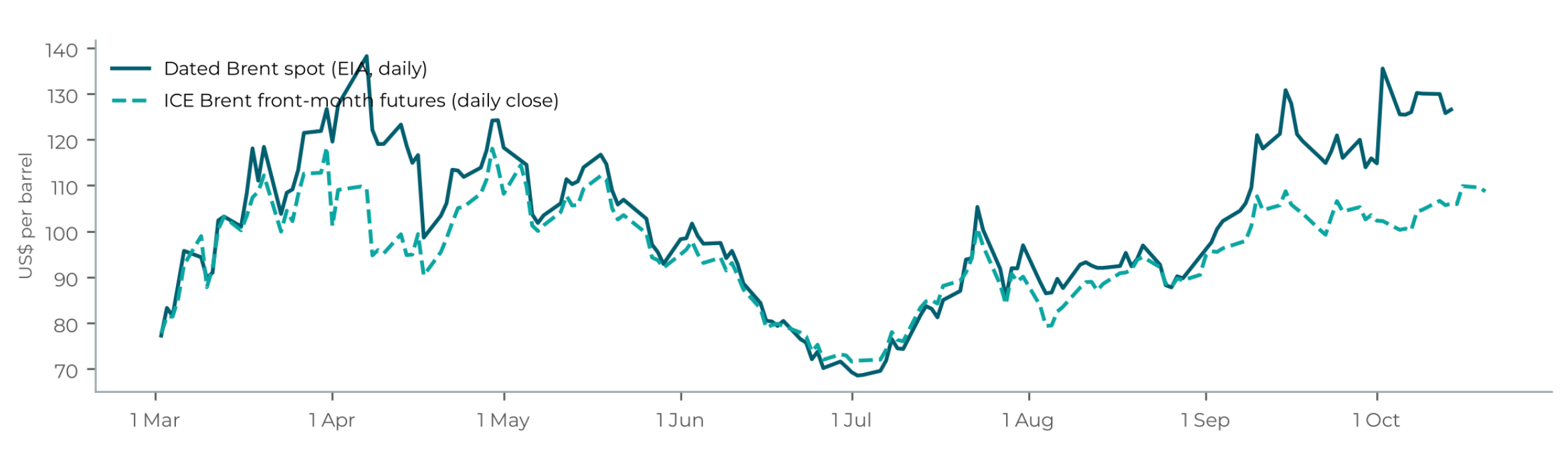


Monthly, lagged about two months. Saudi Arabia does not publish daily export figures and no free daily series exists; JODI is the finest official data. Latest month: July 2026, 4.12 million b/d. Daily cargo-level estimates need a paid tanker-tracking feed (Kpler, Vortexa).

Sources: JODI-Oil via Reuters: Mar (Reuters, 20 May) · Apr (Reuters, 21 Jul (revised from 3.990)) · May (Reuters, 21 Jul) · Jun (Reuters via BOE Report, 20 Aug) · Jul (Reuters via Zawya, 22 Sep).

BRENT CRUDE (US$ PER BARREL)

$108.69	$126.55	+4%	+64%
BRENT FUTURES, LATEST	DATED BRENT SPOT (EIA)	SPOT, 30-DAY CHANGE	SPOT, SINCE 1 MARCH
ICE front-month, 8:43 PM, Tue 20 Oct AST (-0.8% on day). Near real time.	Wed 14 Oct. Daily, published with a lag of several business days.	From $121.25 on Mon 14 Sep.	From $77.24 on Mon 2 Mar; peak $138.21 on Tue 7 Apr.



Sources: US EIA, Europe Brent Spot Price FOB (RBRTE), daily, official, lagged; ICE Brent futures (BZ=F) via Yahoo Finance, delayed quote; weekend values are Friday's close. Physical Dated Brent has traded well above futures since the Gulf disruption, so the two lines differ.

METHOD AND LIMITS

7 What the numbers are, and are not.

- Airport figures (last takeoff and landing, counts, cancellations, diversions, charts, halts) come from the Flightradar24 RUH and DMM boards fetched at 8:52 PM, all pages for the local day. Flightradar24 is an unofficial aggregator, not a GACA or airport feed, and actual times can lag by a few minutes.
- Halts are computed per airport from the boards: any gap of 45 minutes or more with no takeoff or landing. Dammam's status level is set automatically (halted if a halt is open; disrupted if 8%+ cancelled, 3+ diversions or a halt in the last 6 hours) unless set by hand.
- Escalation events come from strikes.json; each has a source link. Economy data are lagged: PortWatch by 4 to 7 days, JODI exports by about two months, EIA spot Brent by several business days; the Brent futures quote is near real time.
- Confidence tags: CONFIRMED = official statement made, or directly checked; CORROBORATED = multiple independent reports consistent with board data; UNVERIFIED = single or social reports not confirmed officially. Claims are attributed to their source.

PREPARED	BOARD DATA AS OF	SOURCES	STATUS	HANDLING	NEXT UPDATE
8:52 PM, Tue 20 Oct	8:52 PM	Flightradar24, GACA, AIS/NOTAC, Reuters, AP, AFP, BBC, Sabq, Gulf News, Arab News, SPA	**RUH Halted · DMM Disrupted**	Open sources · not official	12:00 AM

Sources: Flightradar24, IMF PortWatch, JODI, EIA, Reuters, AP, AFP, SPA · Check your airline · Next update 12:00 AM